

Trainings ▾

General Information

CAUTION

Do not use diesel engine lubricating oil in a natural gas engine. If diesel engine lubricating oil is used, valve torching, piston scuffing, and reduction of spark plug life will occur.

Cummins® natural gas engines require special lubricating oil that is available from major lubricating oil suppliers. Careful attention **must** be paid to engine lubricating oil specifications, because natural gas engine lubricating oil has different properties than diesel engine lubricating oil.

The use of correct engine lubricating oils, combined with appropriate lubricating oil drain and lubricating oil filter change intervals, is a critical factor in maintaining engine performance and durability. A sharp increase in component wear and damage can occur if lubricating oil and filter maintenance intervals are **not** followed as outlined in the maintenance schedule.

Cummins Inc. recommends the use of a high-quality multi-viscosity heavy-duty engine lubricating oil that meets the requirements of Cummins® Engineering Specifications (CES) for natural gas engines. For further details and an explanation of engine lubricating oils for Cummins® engines, refer to Fluids for Cummins® Products Service Manual, Bulletin 5411406.

Shortened drain intervals can be required with single-grade lubricating oils, as determined by close monitoring of the lubricating oil condition with scheduled lubricating oil sampling. Use of single-grade lubricating oils can affect engine lubricating oil control.

Synthetic engine lubricating oils, American Petroleum Institute (API) Group III and Group IV base stocks, are recommended for use in Cummins® engines operating in ambient temperature conditions consistently below -25°C [-13°F]. Synthetic 0W-30 lubricating oils that meet API Group III and Group IV base stocks can be used in operations where the ambient temperature never exceeds 0°C [32°F]. Higher cylinder wear can be experienced when using 0W-30 lubricating oils in high-load situations.

As the engine lubricating oil becomes contaminated, essential lubricating oil additives are depleted. Lubricating oils protect the engine while these additives are functioning properly.

Progressive contamination of the lubricating oil between lubricating oil and filter change intervals is normal. The amount of contamination will vary, depending on the operation of the engine, time on the lubricating oil, fuel consumed, and new lubricating oil added.

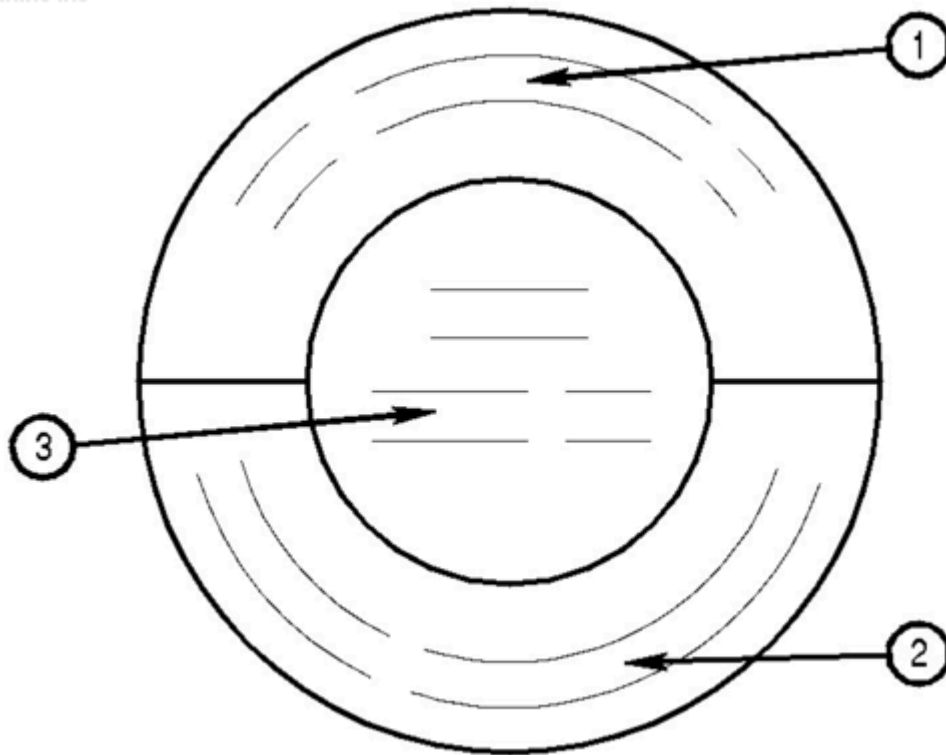
Note : Lubricating oil for natural gas engines does not darken and look dirty like diesel lubricating oil does. Use the maintenance schedule to determine the

lubricating oil change interval requirement, not the lubricating oil's appearance.

Additional information regarding lubricating oil availability throughout the world is available in the Engine Manufacturing Association, Lubricating oils Data Book for Heavy Duty Automotive and Industrial Engines. The data book can be ordered from:

- Truck and Engine Manufacturers Association
- 333 West Wacker Drive
- Suite 810
- Chicago, IL, U.S.A. 60606
- Phone: (312) 929-1970
- Facsimile: (312) 929-1975
- **Note :** <http://www.truckandenginemanufacturers.org/>
(<http://www.truckandenginemanufacturers.org/>)

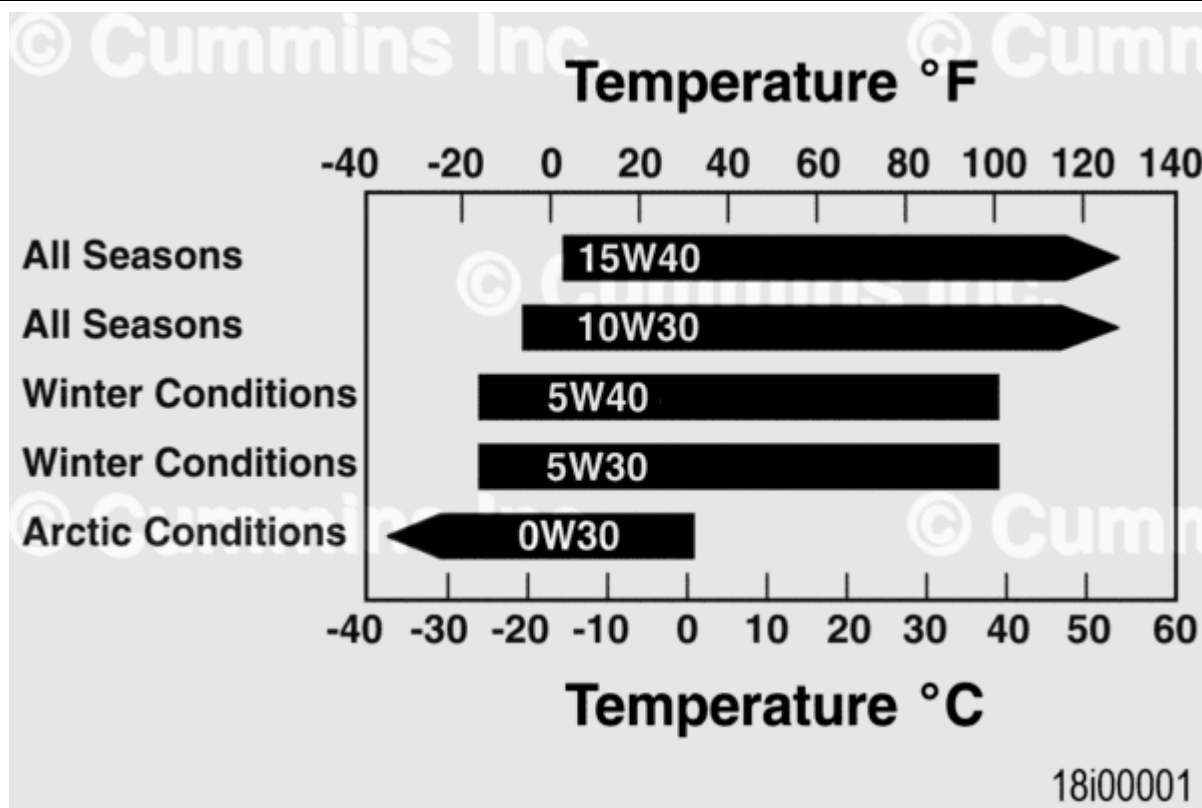
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The API service symbols are shown in the accompanying illustration.

1. The upper half of the symbols display the appropriate lubricating oil categories.
2. The lower half contains words to describe additional lubricating oil information.
3. The center section identifies the Society of Automotive Engineers (SAE) lubricating oil viscosity grade.



Lubricating oil viscosity **must** be chosen according to the typical climate conditions experienced by the user. Use of 15W-40 is recommended for the best engine durability at higher ambient temperatures. For cold conditions 5W-30 viscosity can be used for easier starting, improved lubricating oil flow, and improved fuel economy. Use of 10W-30 is recommended for normal engine operation and provides the best wear protection.

AfterMarket Oil Additive Usage

Cummins Inc. does **not** recommend the use of aftermarket lubricating oil additives. High-quality engine lubricating oils are very sophisticated, with precise amounts of additives blended into the lubricating oil to meet stringent requirements defined in Cummins Engineering Standards (CES).

These furnished lubricating oils meet performance characteristics that conform to the lubricant industry standards. Aftermarket lubricating oil additives are **not** necessary to enhance engine lubricating oil performance and, in some cases, can reduce the finished lubricating oil's capability to protect the engine.

New Engine Break-in Oils

Special break-in engine lubricating oils are **not** recommended for new or rebuilt Cummins® engines. Use the same lubricating oil that will be used during normal operation.

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